

MOVIE RECAP CHANNEL

Channel Growth & Monetization Plan

What will change in movie choice, scripts, titles, thumbnails and editing to get the channel monetized by November 2026.

PREPARED FOR

David Alozie

DATE

14/10/2026

GOAL

YouTube Partner Program approval

DEADLINE

30 November 2026

1. Summary

The channel's views have been low. The cause is not one thing: the movies picked, the titles, the thumbnails, the scripts and the delivery schedule all need to improve together. This plan copies the working system of a successful recap channel in the same niche (Main Plot Recap, whose recent videos reach 60K–211K views) and applies it to every upload from now on, with original scripts and designs.

The plan in one line

Pick movies at the right time, write fast and clear recap scripts, package each video with a long curiosity title and a text-free emotional thumbnail, edit in a clean cinematic style, and upload on a fixed schedule with no missed dates.

Two commitments, starting immediately

- **Delivery is fixed from today.** Past delivery has not been good enough. Every video will now follow the fixed weekly schedule in section 8, with each finished video ready at least 24 hours before its publish time.
- **Tools are no longer an issue.** All the tools needed for scripting, voice-over, editing and thumbnails are now in place, so production will not be held up by missing software or access.

2. The monetization target

To join the YouTube Partner Program with long-form videos, the channel needs:

Requirement	Target	Where we are on 14/10/2026
Subscribers	1,000	_____
Public watch hours (last 12 months)	4,000 hours	_____
Alternative to watch hours: Shorts views (last 90 days)	10 million	_____

These are YouTube's long-standing thresholds. YouTube can change them, so confirm the current numbers in YouTube Studio → Earn before applying. The "where we are" column is filled in from YouTube Studio on the plan date.

What it takes in numbers

4,000 hours = 240,000 minutes of watch time
A 15-minute recap watched for about 6 minutes on average (40%)
 $240,000 \div 6 = \text{about } 40,000 \text{ views of long videos in total}$

With 3 long videos a week from 14 October to 30 November (about 20 videos), that is an average of about 2,000 views per video, or one or two breakout videos like the 80K–211K hits in this niche. Subscribers come from the same views, and Shorts (section 7) add extra subscribers on top.

Honest note on the deadline

November is ambitious if the channel is starting from a low base. This plan is built to give it the best chance. There is a checkpoint at the end of Week 4 (8 November) to compare numbers against target and adjust the movie choices and upload count if needed.

3. Movie choice

What changes

Movies will be chosen for timing and story, not just because they are well known. Recap viewers search for a movie in the days after it reaches streaming, so the aim is to post on or near that day.

How every movie is scored

1. **Timing:** arriving on streaming or digital in the next 3–14 days, so the script can be ready before release.
2. **Recap-friendly story:** one clear hero under pressure, rising danger, a betrayal or twist, and a strong ending.
3. **Searchability:** a known star, franchise, director or viral moment.
4. **Thumbnail moment:** one frozen image that sells the whole movie.
5. **Competition:** fewer big recap channels covering it is better.
6. **Fit:** matches the genres that work in this niche: survival, action-thriller, historical revenge, horror.
7. **Ad safety:** avoid movies whose plot is mostly sexual content or child harm.

First movie shortlist (October–November 2026)

Movie	Where / when	Why
The Death of Robin Hood	HBO Max, 16 Oct	First pick. Dark medieval outlaw story. Closest match to the niche's 211K-view hit. Script ready before release.
Evil Dead Burn	HBO Max, 2 Oct	Brutal horror with a family twist. Strong Halloween demand.
Insidious: Out of the Further	Digital, 6 Oct	Big franchise name, easy to search.
Fall 2: Deadpoint	PVOD, 6 Oct	Sequel to a hit. Survival 3,000 ft up makes a simple, strong thumbnail.
Beast of War	VOD (confirm date)	WWII soldiers on a shrinking raft. Military survival.
Backrooms (A24)	HBO Max, September	A24's highest-grossing film. Mystery plot that viewers want explained.
Disclosure Day	Peacock, October	Spielberg blockbuster many people missed in cinemas.
The Drift	VOD	Arctic ice-floe survival. Small film, little competition.

Dates are taken from news and streaming listings and must be confirmed on the platform before each video is scheduled. New picks are added every week using the movie-picks master prompt.

4. Script

What changes

Every script now follows one fixed recap style, written from a proper plot source (full plot summary, subtitles or notes from watching the movie), so nothing is guessed or made up.

Style rules

- No intro and no greeting. The first sentence starts the story.
- Open with the most dramatic moment, then "The story goes back to..."
- Third person, present tense, plain spoken English.
- One plot event per sentence, 8–20 words, always moving forward.
- Explain why things matter right away ("That means...").
- Real numbers from the movie: years, distances, ages.
- Clear twist lines: "And here it comes out that..."
- The whole movie including the ending, no opinions or reviews.

Format rules

- **Length:** about 3,000 words (around 15 minutes).
- **Pace:** about 200 words a minute.
- **Chapters:** 8–12, one every 1–2 minutes, with plain names.
- **Ending:** "And with this, the story ends right here. Do tell us in the comments how you liked this explanation. And don't forget to like the video and subscribe to the channel."
- **Originality:** every sentence written fresh. No copying from other channels or summaries.

5. Titles

What changes

Titles will stop naming the movie and start selling the story. In this niche the most-viewed titles never include the movie name, year, actors or the words "recap" or "explained".

A [label for the hero] [what happens], [But / So / Where / When / Not Knowing]
[bigger twist]

- Start with a label, not a name: "A Poor Farmer", "An Ex-Soldier", "A Loser Kid".
- Two parts: a setup, then a bigger, crazier second half.
- Irony and scale: an ordinary person next to a huge outcome. The niche's biggest hits all do this.
- One exact number where possible (10,000 Men, 12 Hours) and one strong word (Brutal, Secretly, Entire).
- Title Case, 90–115 characters, with the most clickable words in the first 70.
- Exaggerate the tone, never the facts. Everything in the title must happen in the movie.

Example for The Death of Robin Hood

"The World Calls Him a Hero, But This Dying Outlaw Knows He Was a Murderer and Gets One Last Chance at Salvation"

Written from the official synopsis. It will be updated with the real twist once the movie is watched.

6. Thumbnails

What changes

Thumbnails become clean, cinematic and emotional, built from real movie frames, with no text. The title does the talking and the thumbnail shows the exact moment the title describes.

Rule	What it means
No text	No words, arrows, emojis or logos on the image.
One big emotional face	Screaming, terrified, furious or haunted. It fills 30–40% of the frame.
Reacting characters	1–3 people or a crowd behind the hero to add scale.
One hook object	A weapon, monster or strange object that makes people curious.
Blood, dirt and sweat	Wherever the genre allows, to show high stakes instantly.
Colour grade	Warm skin tones against teal or green backgrounds, deep blacks, sharp. Movie-poster look, 16:9.
Title and thumbnail match	Together they tell one story.
No real actor faces made with AI	Use real frames from the movie or trailer. AI is only used for mock-ups.

7. Editing style

What changes

Every video is edited in one consistent cinematic style that keeps viewers watching for longer, which is what earns watch hours.

Area	The standard
Narration	One calm, clear voice at about 200 words a minute. It never stops and stays at full volume.
Footage	Movie clips matched to every sentence. A new shot every 3–5 seconds.
Movie audio	Muted. Only 1–2 seconds of a real line or sound effect at key moments.
Music	Quiet, tense, royalty-free music at 15–20%, rising at the twist and the climax.

On screen	Clean full-frame footage. No captions, stickers or zoom effects. A small chapter label is optional.
Structure	No intro, cold open, chapters every 1–2 minutes, one-line outro.
Length	12–16 minutes, so mid-roll ads are possible once monetized (8 minutes and over).
Export	1080p or 4K, 16:9, with chapter timestamps in the description.

Shorts

Each long video also gets 2–3 Shorts cut from its own narrated recap (the hook and the biggest twist), each ending with a reason to watch the full video. Shorts bring in new subscribers. Shorts views do not count towards the 4,000 watch hours.

Copyright protection

This is the biggest risk to monetization

- YouTube reviews recap channels for "reused content" before approving them. Our own fully written narration over every second of footage is what makes the videos original. Clips are never uploaded without narration.
- Clips are kept short, and the movie's own audio and music are not used as the soundtrack.
- New studio movies often get Content ID claims. A claim usually means the ad money goes to the studio. A strike is more serious, and three strikes remove the channel.
- The copyright tab in YouTube Studio is checked after every upload and any problem is reported the same day.

8. Delivery schedule

From 14 October, the channel posts **3 long videos every week (Tuesday, Thursday and Saturday)** plus Shorts. A video can move to a different day to land on a movie's streaming release day. Each video goes through the same fixed steps so nothing is late.

Step	What happens	Done by
1. Movie	Movie picked and its streaming date confirmed	Publish day minus 4
2. Script	Plot source gathered, script written and checked	Publish day minus 3
3. Voice + edit	Narration recorded and video edited to the standard in section 7	Publish day minus 2
4. Package	Title and thumbnail made and checked against the rules	Publish day minus 1
5. Ready	Uploaded and scheduled with description, chapters and end screen	At least 24 hours before publish
6. Check	Copyright tab, first-day views and click-through rate reviewed	Publish day plus 1

Week-by-week plan

Week	Focus
Week 1 14–18 Oct	Switch every step to the new system. The Death of Robin Hood goes out on Friday 16 Oct, its streaming release day. One or two more videos from the shortlist. First Shorts.
Week 2 19–25 Oct	3 videos. Halloween horror picks (Evil Dead Burn, Insidious). Compare click-through rates of the new titles and thumbnails against the old videos.
Week 3 26 Oct–1 Nov	3 videos. Lean into whichever genre performed best in Weeks 1–2.
Week 4 2–8 Nov	3 videos. Checkpoint: subscribers and watch hours against target. Adjust the plan if behind.
Week 5 9–15 Nov	3 videos. Repeat the formats of the best-performing videos.
Week 6 16–22 Nov	3 videos. Push Shorts that link to the best long videos.
Week 7 23–30 Nov	3 videos. Apply for the Partner Program as soon as both thresholds are reached.

9. Weekly report

Every week, David receives a short report with these numbers from YouTube Studio:

Number	Why it matters	Healthy level for this niche
Subscribers gained	Progress towards 1,000	Rising every week
Watch hours (12 months)	Progress towards 4,000	Rising every week
Click-through rate	Shows if titles and thumbnails work	Above 5%
Average view duration	Shows if script and editing hold attention	Above 35–40% of the video
Videos delivered on time	Delivery commitment	3 out of 3
Copyright claims or strikes	Risk to monetization	No strikes

10. Agreement

This plan starts immediately on 14/10/2026. Delivery will follow the schedule in section 8, and production tools are now fully in place.

Client: David Alozie

Channel manager

Signature & date

Signature & date